

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 967

By Terry

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the Oakland High School football team, TSSAA Division I, Class 6A state champions.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to specially honor and commend those successful high school teams that, through their magnificent exploits, bring honor to Tennessee and serve as exceptional ambassadors for this State; and

WHEREAS, the Oakland High School football team achieved an extraordinary level of success during the 2025 season, winning the coveted Tennessee Secondary School Athletic Association (TSSAA) Division I, Class 6A State Football Championship for the second consecutive year and the ninth time in school history; and

WHEREAS, the Oakland Patriots claimed the title of state champions by defeating previously unbeaten Ravenwood High School by a score of 62-21 in the BlueCross Bowl championship game on December 6, 2025, at Finley Stadium in Chattanooga; and

WHEREAS, on their advance to the championship game, the Patriots defeated Cookeville 42-10, Bradley Central 35-10, Green Hill 21-17, and Blackman 42-14 before their final victory over Ravenwood to secure the right to hoist the iconic gold football trophy; and

WHEREAS, an offensive juggernaut in the championship game, the Oakland Patriots were led by game MVP Craig Tutt, who had 226 rushing yards and seven touchdowns, tying a state championship record for most touchdowns; and

WHEREAS, finishing their season with a perfect 15-0 record, the 2025 Oakland Patriots enjoyed the services of an outstanding coaching staff led by Head Coach Kevin Creasy, who instilled in these exceptional young men a commitment to excellence in all that they do and encouraged maximum effort on the football field; and

WHEREAS, state championships are achieved only through hard work, dedication, and the ability to work together as a team and excel with a cooperative spirit; the Patriots exhibited each of these rare qualities during their championship season; and

WHEREAS, the football players of Oakland High School epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved the highest level of success on the field while showing the highest degree of character both on and off the gridiron; they inspired their fellow students and united the entire community during their triumphant run through the 2025 season; and

WHEREAS, the dedication, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young men not only made possible a championship football season but also surely bode well for their success in every future endeavor; and

WHEREAS, we find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the football players of Oakland High School for serving as exemplars of the high quality of the youth of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate the players, coaching staff, team support staff, administrators, cheerleaders, and fans of the Oakland High School football team on winning the 2025 TSSAA Division I, Class 6A State Football Championship.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.